concerns, and communication problems with other teams. You note a few main points:

- It is tough to evolve systems. The Data team creates data pipelines directly integrated with the system of record databases or spreadsheets maintained by different teams. Development teams cannot easily change database or spreadsheet schema, which requires weeks of communication with the Data team. For example, to prepare financial reports, the Data team downloads the movie production cost spreadsheets created by the Messflix Production team and stored in the Hitchcock system, maintained by the Orange team.
- Every release requires testing and a sign-off from the system of record and the central data teams.
- System developer teams are overflooded with bugs raised by the Data team (e.g., data pipelines break if someone from the business team makes an error filling out the spreadsheet).

Then you interview the Data team and ask about their collaboration with system of records teams. This is what you hear:

- The Data team members don’t understand the data they are responsible for. It’s impossible to be an expert in all aspects of various data types: financial, content production, market, etc.
- It is hard to extract meaningful data from other teams’ databases or files, because schemas are not self-explanatory. For example, the movie production cost spreadsheet uses unexplained acronyms as column names.
- The work is tedious because of the need to constantly fix broken data pipelines.
- The Data team is asked to prepare analyses on top of the company data. Still, that data is hidden inside the systems, and extracting that data slows new initiatives. Good examples are the scripts and cast datasets hidden in the Hitchcock system. This data could be used to automate the ideation phase of content.